Research Specialist - Vertebrate Collections Manager

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Research Specialist - Vertebrate Collections Manager

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Off-Campus: Mesa/Tempe

Full time

Posted Yesterday

End Date: February 14, 2025 (9 days left to apply)

JR102301

Department Statement:
The School of Life Sciences (SOLS) has provided a vital hub for creative excellence at Arizona State University, with more than 670 faculty, graduate students, postdoctoral fellows and staff, and research that ranges from studies on biodiesel and biohydrogen to vaccine development and the conservation of whales. As ASU's first academic unit to fully reflect President Michael Crow's integrated, interdisciplinary vision for the New American University, the School of Life Sciences offers active and evolving platforms for collaborative, cutting-edge research and faculty whose discovery is freed from traditional institutional boundaries.

Job Profile:
Lab and Research Specialist 2

Job Family:

Research Specialist - Vertebrate Collections Manager

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$64,700.00 USD Annual

Job Description:

The School of Life Sciences at Arizona State University (https://sols.asu.edu/) is seeking a full-time **Research Specialist** who will serve as the Vertebrate Collections Manager for the ASU Natural History Collections (ASUNHC). The position is part of a dynamic, collaborative biocollections and biodiversity data science group of faculty, staff, students, volunteers, and other researchers. The ASUNHC is co-located with the National Ecological Observatory Network (NEON) Biorepository (https://www.neonscience.org/data-samples) in a unified 28,000 sq. ft. facility, collectively referred to as the ASU Biocollections. The facility is ca. 2 miles southwest of the main ASU Tempe Campus, and forms part of ASU's Biodiversity Knowledge Integration Center (BioKIC; https://biokic.asu.edu/)

The ASUNHC Vertebrate Collections are primarily focused on documenting vertebrate diversity in the Southwestern U.S. and Sonoran Desert Region, and comprise the following four collections: (1) Ichthyology, with 24,000 registered lots and more than 1,000 stained specimens; built most prominently by Wendell Minckley (70% digitized/online); (2) Herpetology, with 36,000 specimens (90% digitized/online); (3) Ornithology contains over 1500 specimens (>90% digitized/online); and (4) Mammalogy, with 9,000 specimens (95% digitized/online). The research collections are complemented by teaching collections located on site. The ASUNHC Vertebrate Collections Manager will work synergistically with the NEON collection managers, who archive, curate, and make available to the research community an additional 20,000+ vertebrate specimens and samples collected annually from 81 field sites spanning the entire US.

BioKIC is a leading promoter of the Symbiota software platform (http://symbiota.org/) and is co-managing an increasing range of biodiversity data portals that also feature vertebrate occurrence records. We therefore seek a candidate with a demonstrated background and/or willingness to become skilled in biodiversity informatics, portal management, and digitization workflows. We also strongly encourage the candidate to develop an active field- and collections-based research program at a level commensurate with the position, and possibly including systematic biodiversity, inventory, and ecological forecasting-related themes. The successful candidate will work in close collaboration with curators, collection managers, students, and researchers affiliated with the Biocollections and the School of Life Sciences. Contributing to our diverse biodiversity/data learning programs is strongly encouraged. A wide range of applicant profiles will be considered. Candidates who may not be immediately available to start in the position are nevertheless encouraged to apply.

Salary Range: $50,000 - $64,700; depending on experience

Essential Duties:

- Comprehensive management of the ASUNHC Vertebrate Collections, including physical and digital data holdings.
- Specimen-level curation and coordination of regular collection/research activities involving organization and conservation, information quality, growth, exchanges and loans, and other collection

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- Regular collaboration and communication with ASUNHC and NEON collection managers to ensure seamless coordination of equipment and infrastructure management tasks, particularly in shared spaces, promoting a synergistic approach to effective teamwork and shared success.
- Participation in diverse, vertebrate-focused, in-person or online learning and outreach activities; including opportunities for instruction and course development.
- Recruiting, training, and supervising graduate and under-graduate students and volunteers.
- Managing donations and expanding the collections

Desired Qualifications:

- Master's or Doctoral degree in vertebrate biology, or a related field with a focus on systematics, evolution, ecology, conservation, or vertebrate diversity documentation and forecasting using modern informatics tools.
- Working knowledge of the Symbiota platform.
- Evidence of advanced, research-level expertise in vertebrate groups.
- Curatorial skills will ideally include specialized vertebrate specimen and sample preparation methods such as taxidermy.
- Two or more years of curatorial experience in vertebrate research collections, including supervisory and mentoring roles.
- Familiarity with, and willingness to secure and maintain State, Federal, and institutional scientific collecting permits.
- Evidence of effective verbal and written communication skills.
- Experience in contemporary biodiversity data standards and tools.
- Experience in collections-centered teaching and outreach activities is highly valued.
- Demonstrated commitment to the ASU Charter (https://www.asu.edu/about/charter-mission)

Working Environment:

- Daily, on-site position with occasional field work (not a remote position).
- Standard scientific research laboratory and collections facility environment requiring sitting, standing, walking, climbing stairs, bending and lifting moderate loads (20-50 lbs).
- Occasional strenuous hiking during field work.

Minimum Qualifications:
Bachelor's degree and three (3) years of experience appropriate to the area of assignment/field; OR, Any equivalent combination of experience and/or training from which comparable knowledge, skills and abilities have been achieved.

Driving Requirement:
Driving is not required for this position.

Location:

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Instructions to Apply

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https://www.myworkday.com/asu/d/inst/1$9925/9925$2321.htmld
To be considered, your application **must** include **all** of the following attachments:

- Cover letter
- Resume/CV

Note: Multiple documents can be submitted into the attachment box. Alternatively, merge all documents into one PDF for submission.

Please include all employment information in month/year format (e.g., 6/88 to 8/94), job title, job duties and name of employer for each position. Resume should clearly illustrate how prior knowledge and experience meets the Minimum and Desired qualifications of this position. NOTE: GA and Intern positions are counted as .5 for job experience (ie. 1 year equals 6 months experience equivalency). Only electronic applications are accepted for this position.

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ASU Statement
Arizona State University is a new model for American higher education, an unprecedented combination of academic excellence, entrepreneurial energy and broad access. This New American University is a single, unified institution comprising four differentiated campuses positively impacting the economic, social, cultural and environmental health of the communities it serves. Its research is inspired by real world application blurring the boundaries that traditionally separate academic disciplines. ASU serves more than 100,000 students in metropolitan Phoenix, Arizona, the nation's fifth largest city. ASU champions intellectual and cultural diversity, and welcomes students from all fifty states and more than one hundred nations across the globe.

ASU is a tobacco-free university. For details visit
https://wellness.asu.edu/explore-wellness/body/alcohol-and-drugs/tobacco

Arizona State University is a VEVRAA Federal Contractor and an Equal Opportunity/Affirmative Action Employer. All qualified applicants will receive consideration for employment without regard to race, color, religion, sex,

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https://www.asu.edu/police/PDFs/ASU-Clery-Report.pdf. You may request a hard copy of the report by contacting the ASU Police Department at 480-965-3456.

Relocation Assistance – For information about schools, housing child resources, neighborhoods, hospitals, community events, and taxes, visit https://cfo.asu.edu/az-resources.

Employment Verification Statement
ASU conducts pre-employment screening which may include verification of work history, academic credentials, licenses, and certifications.

Background Check Statement
ASU conducts pre-employment screening for all positions which includes a criminal background check, verification of work history, academic credentials, licenses, and certifications. Employment is contingent upon successful passing of the background check.

Fingerprint Check Statement
A fingerprint check is not required for this position.

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